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F L E A N E W S

No. 9

of Science and Technology

Compiled by the Custodian of the Rothschild Collection of
Siphonaptera, Department of Entomology, British Museum
(Natural History), South Kensington, London SW7 5BD

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Please find herewith:

- lists of additional literature for 1975 (list 6) and 1976 (list 2)
- information and a questionnaire concerning the 1977 International Conference on Fleas

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PERSONALIA - With sadness we record the death of Miss Hilda JORDAN on Monday, 16.VIII.1976, aged 84 years. The elder of the two daughters of the late Dr Karl Jordan, she devoted much of her life to looking after her father, especially after the death of Mrs Jordan in 1927. Hilda often escorted her father on his various journeys and collecting trips. Her filial devotion was exemplary. Those of us who visited Tring in days gone by will fondly remember the cordial hospitality extended to them by the Jordan sisters. - Our sympathies go to Miss Ada Jordan, Hilda's surviving sister.

It was a pleasure to learn that the German Entomological Society awarded their Fabricius medal for 1975 to our colleague and friend Professor Dr Fritz PEUS on 3.II.1976. - (See: G. Becker, 1976, Laudatio anlässlich der Verleihung der Fabricius-Medaille der Deutschen Entomologischen Gesellschaft an Herrn Professor Dr. Fritz Peus am 3.2.1976, Mitt. Dtsch. ent. Ges. 34: 65-68. - F. Peus, 1976, Dankesworte anlässlich der Verleihung der Fabricius-Medaille, l.c.: 69-72. - A. W. Steffan, 1976, Fabricius-Preisträger 1975: Professor Dr. Fritz Peus, Berlin, Ent. germ. 2: 388-393, 7 figs.)

Congratulations to Dr J. C. BEAUCOURNU who, on 10.VII.1976, earned the title of Docteur ès Sciences Naturelles by successfully defending his fine thesis "Contribution à l'étude des Siphonaptères des mammifères du nord-ouest de la région méditerranéenne (France, Italie, Péninsule Ibérique)".

Time does go fast. It is difficult to realize that my correspondence with Dr George P. HOLLAND started 30 years ago and that by now he has retired (27.VIII.1976) from active service with the Entomology Research Branch of Agriculture Canada. Happily for all concerned, Dr Holland is definitely not relinquishing his great interest in fleas and we may therefore fortunately look forward to more very valuable contributions from his hand.

* * *

AFRICANA - The recently established Institute of Entomology and Parasitology of Africa (INEPA), U.S.T., Kumasi, Ghana (director: Prof. A. Bob Stam), intends to foster "more contacts between all entomologists and parasitologists working in or about Africa south of the Sahara as well as the medical or the veterinary field as in agriculture or in general entomology." "...INEPA's principal aim is to be an interafrican contact and documentation centre..." The Institute issues Newsletters (free; in English or French) and its library would appreciate receiving reprints on topics dealing with the African fauna. Requests for Newsletters to be addressed to Professor Stam.

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Attention is drawn to a very useful publication: Udvardy, M.D.F., 1975, A classification of the biographical provinces of the world. Occas. Paper int. Union Conservation Nature (18): 1-48, 10 maps.

* * *

"Very little that any individual discovers in a lifetime is really new."

T. W. M. Cameron, 1966

In the title of the 1975 paper by Yershova L.S., Trukhachev N.N. & Afanas'yeva O.V. [see FN 8] I placed a "[?]" after the word 'muscardinis' as I did not know the word and was not certain about the correctness of my translation. Subsequently I read in G. E. Cantwell's Insect diseases I: G13 (1974): "muscardine - a term used generally in connection with those mycoses of insects in which the fruiting of the pathogenic fungi (muscardine fungi) arise on the exterior of the insect."

MAILING LIST

Additions:

- Mr Th. Hallas - Statens skadedyrlaboratorium, Skovbrynet 14, 2800 Lyngby, DENMARK
Dr A. Kissileff - Bethlehem Pike, Flourtown, 19031 Pennsylvania, U.S.A.
Dr M. B. Usher - Department of Biology, University of York, Heslington, York YO1 5DD, ENGLAND

Changes:

- Dr B. G. Bagnall - Animal Health Division, Smith Kline & French Laboratories, Mundells, Welwyn Garden City, Herts. AL7 1EY, ENGLAND
Mr T. G. Schwan - Division of Entomology and Parasitology, University of California, Berkeley, California 94720, U.S.A.

OH, THESE THESES ! - Dr Beaucournu's thesis, referred to overleaf, prompts me to make the following observations: -
We find listed on p. 56: C. (Ctenophthalmus) egregius garganus Beaucournu et Grulich, sous presse; on p. 60: C. (Euctenophthalmus) savii matilei Beaucournu et Grulich, sous presse; in "Annexe 1": Hystrichopsylla talpae riouxi Beaucournu et Rosin. In "Annexe 2" short diagnoses, without illustrations, are given of these new taxa "... afin qu'ils ne puissent être considérés comme nomina nuda..." Although the thesis was produced by offset-photolithography (as is common nowadays), the edition is extremely limited - Dr Beaucournu kindly informed me that only 50 copies were made - and it may therefore be virtually impossible to obtain a copy. I believe that for practical purposes this thesis should be regarded as unpublished and it is hoped that proper illustrated descriptions will be published soon in a formal medium.

There are other instances illustrating the undesirability of describing new taxa in similar theses (dissertations).
M. W. Hastriter's M.Sc. thesis "Fleas (Siphonaptera) associated with small mammals of Morocco: their distribution and host-specificity" (Brigham Young University), produced in April 1973, is similar to that of Dr Beaucournu and contains illustrated descriptions of Ctenophthalmus andorrensis opistholatus [recte: opistholatus] n. ssp. and Ctenophthalmus russulae tangerensis n. ssp. Now, C. a. opistholatus is identical with C. a. veletensis Beaucournu, Gilot & Véricad, a name which was published in 1973 without exact date and therefore to be dated 31.XII.1973. If we were to accept Hastriter's thesis as a proper publication, C. a. veletensis would be a junior synonym of C. a. opistholatus (April, 1973). A shortened version of this thesis was published in 1975 by M. W. Hastriter & V. J. Tipton (J. Egypt. publ. Hlth Ass. 50[2]) and includes descriptions of C. russulae tangerensis n. ssp. and Leptopsylla algira agadirensis n. ssp.; thus these authors regarded the 1973 thesis as unpublished and in their 1975 paper therefore used the name C. a. veletensis instead of C. a. opistholatus.

Another example, but without complications: Dr H. Ribeiro's 1974 thesis "Sifonápteros de Angola", including full descriptions of 11 new taxa, was produced also by photo-litho offset in a very small edition but fortunately subsequently properly published in 1975 (Anais Inst. Hig. Med. trop. Lisb. 2[1-4]).

Recommendation: one should not include new taxa, or at least not name them, in a thesis (dissertation) which will be issued in only a very limited number of copies (e.g., fewer than 100).

LITERATURE ON SIPHONAPTERA PUBLISHED IN 1975 (list 6)

- Anonymous - Instructions for determining the susceptibility or resistance of fleas to insecticides. WHO (Genève). 6 pp.
- Brygoo, E.R. - Bibliographie médicale de Madagascar antérieure à 1968. Premier complément. Arch. Inst. Pasteur Madagascar 44(1): 217-244.
- Brygoo, E.R. - Bibliographie de la zoologie parasitaire des vertébrés de Madagascar. Arch. Inst. Pasteur Madagascar 44(1): 245-288.
- Ito, S., Vinson, W. & McGuire, T.J. - Murine typhus rickettsiae in the oriental rat flea. Annals N. Y. Acad. Sci. 266: 35-60, figs. 1-17.
- Joseph, S.A. - Incidence and ecology of the flea, *Ctenocephalides felis felis* (Bouché), 1835 of the palm civet *Paradoxurus hermaphroditus* (Pallas) of the Pensinsular India. Cheiron (Madras) 4(2): 137-139, 1 fig.
- Msangi, A.S. - The surveillance of rodent populations in East Africa in relation to plague endemicity. Univ. Sci. J., Dar es Salaam 1(1): 8-20.
- Padgett, G., Bell, T.G. & Farrell, K. - Dichlorvos flea collar ataxia-depression and dermatitis in the laboratory cat. Feder. Proc. 34(3): 245.
- Schillhorn van Veen, T.W. & Mohammed, A.N. - Louse and flea infestations on small ruminants in the Zaria area. J. Nig. vet. med. Ass. 4(2): 93-96, figs. 1-2.
- Suciu, M. - The collection of fleas from the Natural History Museum of Verona. Boll. Mus. civ. Stor. nat. Verona 2: 1-12.
- Vinson, J.V. - Pathogenic rickettsiae and their arthropods: an introduction. Annals N. Y. Acad. Sci. 266: 3-5.
- Watson, G.E. - Birds of the Antarctic and Sub-Antarctic. Washington D.C. (American Geophysical Union). xvii + 350 pp., figs., 11 pls.
- Weiser, J. - Significant recent advances in biological control of vector insects. Adv. vet. Sci. & comp. Med. 19: 47-72.

LITERATURE ON SIPHONAPTERA PUBLISHED IN 1976 (list 2)

- Akiyev, A.K., Yemel'yanov, P.E. & Labunets, N.F. - The European suslik as a possible carrier of plague in natural foci in eastern Europe. J. Hyg. Epidemiol. Microbiol. 20(1): 82-90, 1 fig.
- Alekseyev, A.N. - Changes in the fauna and density of blood-sucking arthropods in different regions of the U.S.S.R. in connection with economic development of the territory. Medit. Parazit. 45(1): 3-14.
- Andrews, M.L.A. - The life that lives on man. London (Faber & Faber). 183 pp., frontispiece, 57 figs. (Siph.: 100-116; plagye: 117-131).
- Anonymous - The United States national entomological collections. Washington D.C. (Smithsonian Institution Press). 47 pp. (Siph.: 27-28).
- Bell, T.G., Farrell, R.K. & Padgett, G.A. - Toxic reactions due to flea collars. J. amer. vet. med. Ass. 168(6): 374-376.
- Bennet-Clark, H.C. - Energy storage in jumping insects. in: H. R. Hepburn (ed.)- The insect integument. (Elsevier Scient. Publ. Co.): 421-443, figs. 23.1-23.5.
- Beveridge, I & Barker, I.K. - The parasites of *Antechinus stuartii* Macleay from Powelltown, Victoria, with observations on seasonal and sex-related variations in numbers of helminths. Aust. J. Zool. 24(2): 265-272, figs. 1-2.
- Broek, E. van den - Hoe lang is de arm van de kattevlo? Vakbl. Biol. 56(15): 247-248, 1 fig.
- Bronswijk, J. E. M. H. van - De lange arm van de kattevlo. Vakbl. Biol. 56(12): 200, figs. 1, 2 [vide etiam l.c.(15): 248].

Coulanges, P. - Service de la peste. Arch. Inst. Pasteur Madagascar 44(2): 381-397.

Cyprich, D., Kiefer, M. & Kminiak, M. - Blchy (Siphonaptera) krysy vodnej (Arvicola terrestris L., 1758) v podmienkach Slovenska. Biológia (Bratislava) 31(8): 573-581.

Eads, R.B. & Barnes, A.M. - Status of *Nosopsyllus londiniensis* (Rothschild, 1905) in the United States (Siphonaptera: Ceratophyllidae). Calif. Vector Views 23(1): 1-3.

Franzmann, N.E. - En undersøgelse af loppefaunaen i nogle højarktiske ynglefugle og reder (Siphonaptera). Ent. Meddel. 44(1): 28-30, fig. 1.

Giroud, M. - Aspects particuliers des maladies infectieuses et parasitaires en milieu rural. J. Méd. Lyon 57(1300): 147-155.

Grinbergs, A. - Latvijās blusu (Siphonaptera) katalogs. Latv. Ent. 18: 5-26, fig. 1.

Gubareva, N.P., Akiyev, A.K., Zemel'man, B.M. & Abdurakhmanov, G.A. - The effect of some factors on block-formation in the fleas *Ceratophyllus tesquorum* and *Neopsylla setosa setosa*. Parazitologiya 10(4): 315-319.

Hallas, T.E. - Lopper. Natur og Museum 17(4): 2-22, figs. 1-25.

Hinaidy, H.K. - Ein weiterer Beitrag zur Parasitenfauna des Rotfuchses, *Vulpes vulpes* (L.), in Österreich. Zbl. vet. Med. (B) 23(1): 66-73, figs. 1-4.

Horak, I.G. - The control of ticks, fleas and lice in dogs by means of a sendran-impregnated collar. J. South Afr. vet. Ass. 47(1): 17-18.

Kodama, J.K., Collins, J.A. & Kempen, K.R. van - Toxic reactions due to flea collars. J. amer. vet. med. Ass. 168(6): 368, 370, 372, 374.

Losev, O.L. - Sovyet literature on the problems of medical parasitology and parasitic diseases in 1975. Medit. Parazit. 45(1): 105-113.

Mahnert, V. - *Alectopsylla unisetosa* nov. gen., nov. spec. (Siphonaptera, Ischnopsyllidae) from Argentina. Rev. suisse Zool. 83(3): 769-776, figs. 1-7.

Marcuzzi, G. - La fauna delle Dolomiti. Calliano (Trento) (Manfrini). 549 pp., 765 figs. (Siph.: 346-348, figs. 530-532).

Ranade, D.R. & Bhalchandra, D.V. - A note on the natural infection in rat flea, *Xenopsylla cheopis* (Roths.) with *Trichinella spiralis* (Owen). J. communic. Dis. 8(1): 77-80, figs. 1-3.

Reinhardt, C. - Ultrastructural comparison of the midgut epithelia of fleas with different feeding behavior patterns (*Xenopsylla cheopis*, *Echidnophaga gallinacea*, *Tunga penetrans*, Siphonaptera, Pulicidae). Acta trop. 33(2): 105-132, figs. 1-24.

Reisen, W.K., Kennedy, M.L. & Reisen, N.T. - Winter ecology of ectoparasites collected from hibernating *Myotis velifer* (Allen) in southwestern Oklahoma (Chiroptera: Vespertilionidae). J. Parasit. 62(4): 628-635.

Smit, F.G.A.M. - A new bird-flea from Nepal. Senckenbergiana biol. 57(1-3): 63-66, figs. 1-3.

Sullivan, W.N., Hayes, D.K., Schechter, M.S., McIntyre, T., Morrison, D.R. & Fisher, M. - Space studies with insects. Bull. ent. Soc. Amer. 22(1): 15-16.

Talybov, A.N. - The development of the immature stages of the flea *Ctenophthalmus wladimiri* Is.-Gurv., 1948. Parazitologiya 10(4): 320-324.

Verhulst, A. - *Tunga penetrans* (*Sarcopsylla penetrans*) as a cause of agalactia in sows in the Republic of Zaïre. Vet. Rec. 98(19): 384.

INTERNATIONAL CONFERENCE ON FLEAS

ASHTON WOLD, PETERBOROUGH, ENGLAND, U.K.

21st — 25th June 1977

Congress Sponsored by: LONDON SCHOOL OF HYGIENE AND TROPICAL MEDICINE : ROYAL ENTOMOLOGICAL SOCIETY OF LONDON

Chairman of Medical Section : DR. N. G. GRATZ (W. H. O.)

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Dr. M. Rothschild

Mr. F.G.A.M. Smit

Prof. R. Traub

All Correspondence to :

THE ORGANISING SECRETARY,

ASHTON WOLD,

ASHTON, PETERBOROUGH, PE 8 SLZ

ENGLAND, U.K.

Telephone : Oundle (08322) 3575

October 1976

Dear Colleague,

The Conference fee will be £15 (to be paid on registration at Ashton Wold).

* * *

An interpreter for Russian will be present.

* * *

EXCURSIONS

There will be three afternoon excursions organised for the delegates (free of cost), namely on Wednesday, Thursday and Friday, from about 1.30 - 7.00 p.m. Transport will be by bus.

The Wednesday -22 June- excursion will comprise a visit to Fotheringhay (where Mary Queen of Scots was beheaded), the duck decoy at Peakirk, Peterborough Cathedral and Burghley House.

The Thursday -23 June- expedition will include a visit to Monk's Wood Experimental Station or the Huntingdon Research Centre (the latter organisation employing 750 chemists) and Woodwalton Fen Nature Reserve. For those who are interested in English literature the party can visit (on the return journey) Little Gidding where T. S. Eliot wrote The Four Quartets.

The Friday -24 June- outing will be to Cambridge University (45 km from Ashton) with visits to the Department of Zoology, the Cambridge University Press, Kings College Chapel, the Fitzwilliam Museum and other places of interest.

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The Organising Committee

INTERNATIONAL CONFERENCE ON FLEAS

ASHTON WOLD, PETERBOROUGH, ENGLAND, U.K.

21st — 25th June 1977

Congress Sponsored by: LONDON SCHOOL OF HYGIENE AND TROPICAL MEDICINE : ROYAL ENTOMOLOGICAL SOCIETY OF LONDON

Chairman of Medical Section : DR. N. G. GRATZ (W. H. O.)

Organising Committee :

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Dr. T. Clay

Dr. M. Rothschild

Mr. F.G.A.M. Smit

Prof. R. Traub

All Correspondence to :

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ASHTON, PETERBOROUGH, PE 8 SLZ

ENGLAND, U.K.

Telephone : Oundle (08322) 3575

October 1976

Dear Colleague,

If you are a prospective participant of the Conference, please complete and return this questionnaire, without much delay, to the organising secretary: Miss J. Beer, Ashton Wold, Ashton, Peterborough PE8 5LZ, England.

Date

Prof./Dr/Mrs/Miss/Mr

Address

- intends to attend the 1977 International Conference on Fleas
- will be accompanied by
- will be reading a paper entitled

- requires the use of a 35 mm projector ?
- desires accommodation

(a) in the village of Ashton in furnished cottages at a cost of £15 (including breakfast) for the duration of the conference, or

(b) in the local hotel at a cost of £10 a night (incl. breakfast).

Please note that prices may be subject to an inflationary increase.

- would like to consult the Rothschild/BMNH collection of fleas at the British Museum (Natural History), London - or not. If so, please indicate whether before or after the Conference and for which specific purpose (if any).
- would like to make the following suggestions, observations or requests